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java.lang.annotation

Annotation Type Target

```
@Documented
 @Retention(value=RUNTIME)
 @Target(value=ANNOTATION_TYPE)
public @interface Target
```

Indicates the contexts in which an annotation type is applicable. The declaration contexts and type contexts in which an annotation type may be applicable are specified in JLS 9.6.4.1, and denoted in source code by enum constants of `java.lang.annotation.ElementType`.

If an `@Target` meta-annotation is not present on an annotation type `T` , then an annotation of type `T` may be written as a modifier for any declaration except a type parameter declaration.

If an `@Target` meta-annotation is present, the compiler will enforce the usage restrictions indicated by `ElementType` enum constants, in line with JLS 9.7.4.

For example, this `@Target` meta-annotation indicates that the declared type is itself a meta-annotation type. It can only be used on annotation type declarations:

```
@Target(ElementType.ANNOTATION_TYPE)
public @interface MetaAnnotationType {
    ...
}
```

This `@Target` meta-annotation indicates that the declared type is intended solely for use as a member type in complex annotation type declarations. It cannot be used to annotate anything directly:

```
@Target({})
public @interface MemberType {
    ...
```

```
}
```

It is a compile-time error for a single `ElementType` constant to appear more than once in an `@Target` annotation. For example, the following `@Target` meta-annotation is illegal:

```
@Target({ElementType.FIELD, ElementType.METHOD, ElementType.FIELD})
public @interface Bogus {
    ...
}
```

Since:

1.5

See *The Java™ Language Specification*:

9.6.4.1 @Target, 9.7.4 Where Annotations May Appear

Required Element Summary

Required Elements

Modifier and Type	Required Element	Description
`ElementType[]`	`value`	Returns an array of the kinds of elements an annotation type can be applied to.

Element Detail

value

```
public abstract ElementType[] value
```

Returns an array of the kinds of elements an annotation type can be applied to.

Returns:

C

```
an array of the kinds of elements an annotation type can be
applied to
```


Submit a bug or feature
For further API reference and developer documentation, see Java SE Documentation. That documentation contains more detailed, developer-targeted descriptions, with conceptual overviews, definitions of terms, workarounds, and working code examples.
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